

Calling Functions: Putting Your Tools to Work

Once a function is defined, you can use it by "calling" it—writing its name followed by parentheses containing any required inputs (arguments).

Basic Function Calls: Executing Your Strategy

Here's how you might call our moving average function:

```
1. # Define a list of stock prices
2. apple_prices = [165.3, 166.7, 164.9, 167.3, 168.8]
3.
4. # Call the function with price data and a 3-day window
5. short_term_ma = calculate_moving_average(apple_prices, 3)
6.
7. print(f"3-day moving average: {short_term_ma}")
8.
```

When this code runs, Python:

1.
Passes the `apple_prices` list as the `prices` parameter
2.
Passes the value 3 as the `window` parameter
3.
Executes the code in the function body using these values
4.
Returns the calculated moving average, which is stored in `short_term_ma`

This simple pattern—define once, call many times—is what makes functions so powerful for trading systems.

Function Arguments: Providing the Inputs

There are several ways to provide inputs to functions:

Positional Arguments

The simplest approach is to provide arguments in the same order as the parameters: